When Your Private Well Runs Out of Water

Question: I live in Hammonds Plains, Nova Scotia. My well has stopped supplying water. Where should I start and who can check it?

Short answer

No water at the taps does not establish that the well is dry. The cause may involve water availability, the pump and pressure system, plumbing or treatment equipment. The first step is to establish what needs attention before choosing a repair or well upgrade.

Where to start

If your private well stops supplying water or repeatedly runs out, contact IL-AirTech Home & Well Inspection for an initial assessment. The problem may involve the well's water supply, household consumption, treatment equipment, plumbing, or the pump and pressure system. We help you understand the findings and guide you through the next steps. If pump repairs or other specialist work are needed, we help you identify the appropriate contractor. Serving Hammonds Plains, Tantallon and surrounding HRM communities.

What if the water returns after waiting

That pattern may indicate that water use is exceeding the well's replenishment, but it does not prove the cause. Equipment faults can also interrupt supply. Record when the water stops, what was running beforehand and how long it takes to return.

What we have observed in the field

During a recent IL-AirTech assessment, measured consumption showed a substantial water demand from automatic treatment equipment. This finding needed to be considered alongside the well's recovery and available storage. It did not, by itself, establish the cause of the shortage. Looking at supply and consumption together helps guide the next investigation.

What to do while arranging help

Reduce non-essential water use and arrange safe drinking water. Do not pour outside water into the well. If the well has run dry, follow provincial guidance on returning it to service and testing before drinking the water again. Do not open electrical controls or attempt down-well repairs yourself.

Request an initial assessment

An initial assessment offers a modest-cost starting point for understanding the problem before committing to potentially expensive repairs or well upgrades. The current assessment fee is shown in our online booking form. Additional investigation or monitoring is quoted separately and requires your approval. A booking is a request, subject to review and confirmation; it is not an emergency dispatch service.

Phone: 902-809-7778 | Email: il.airtech.ns@gmail.com

Service information and assessment scope

Request an appointment

Source: Government of Nova Scotia - Water shortages guidance